



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

I've been trying to reach you all day.



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you talk to your boss or teacher directly?
- What have you been doing at work or school recently?
- Have you asked any favors from anyone?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk about recent actions and routines.
- I can ask someone a favor.





Let's Explore!

Sally calls her boss at the magazine. Ms. Ryan has lots of **loose ends to tie up***.

* This is an idiom meaning that there are things that need to be finished.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Victoria:** Hello?
- Sally:** Oh, hi Victoria. It's Sally. I hope I'm not disturbing you. I've been trying to reach you all day.
- Victoria:** Sally! Yes, I've been running around all day. Our next issue is coming out soon. We have lots of loose ends to tie up here. How are you?
- Sally:** I've been better. I've thrown out my back.
- Victoria:** Oh, I'm sorry to hear that.
- Sally:** Yes, it's quite bad. I may have a slipped disk. I fell down at the bowling alley and haven't been able to walk since.
- Victoria:** That's sounds awful.
- Sally:** I know I have a target date coming up for my article. I'm not sure if I can get it done by end of business day Friday. Would it be okay if I provided you the article next week, not this week?
- Victoria:** Hm, yes, I understand. However, we have deliverables for the publishing house. I'm not sure if we can accommodate a layout change at this point. We've been negotiating with a new publishing house for a different contract. It's still up in the air.
- Sally:** Ok, I'm wondering if I could have it in by Sunday end-of-day?
- Victoria:** I'll have to think about it and get back to you.





Let's Practice!

It's all up in the air!

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Write the missing words correctly. Use words from the box below.

publishing house
contract
target date
layout
article

I know I have a _____ coming up for my _____. I'm not sure if I can get it done by end of business day Friday. However, we have deliverables for the _____. I'm not sure if we can accommodate a _____ change at this point. We've been negotiating with a new publishing house for a different _____.



Let's Practice!

I'd like to ask you a favor.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. be / ok / if / this / provide / Would / the / ? / next / I / week, / not / week / it / you

2. by / could / am / if / have / in / Sunday / end-of-day / I / wondering / I / it / ?

3. you / ? / Could / the / target / reschedule / please / date

4. layout / please / Would / accommodate / ? / a / change, / you

5. wouldn't / mind / if / you / negotiating / a / contract / I'm / wondering / new / ?



Extension Activity

Ask your boss to do you a favor.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine you have to call your boss (or teacher).
- Think of a favor you need to ask them for.
- Tell them what you have been doing lately.
- Write a dialogue including all of these things.
- Practice your dialogue with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I use vocabulary about jobs and work.

☐ ☐

I talk about my recent actions.

☐ ☐

I ask someone for a favor.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **target date** (noun): a deadline
e.g. I know I have a target date coming up for my article.
- **business day** (noun): Monday to Friday, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
e.g. I'm not sure I can get it done by end of business day.
- **to accommodate** (verb): to adapt to a condition
e.g. I'm not sure if we can accommodate a change in schedule.
- **publishing house** (noun): a company that publishes books or magazines
e.g. We have a deadline at the publishing house.
- **deliverable** (noun): a product that is provided
e.g. We have deliverables for the publishing house.
- **layout** (noun): the way that something is visually organized
e.g. We cannot change the layout at this point.





Learning Points

Asking for Favors

There are different ways to ask for favors. Favors are things we would like other people to do for us. It is best to be as polite as possible when asking for favors.

You can use modals to ask for favors.

For example:

Could/Would you + verb, please?

Could you speak up a little, please?

You can also use an if-clause.

For example:

*I was wondering **if you could** give me some ideas to help with the pain.*

*Would it be ok **if I called** tomorrow?*

Examples:

- *Could you please recommend some alternative therapies?*
- *Would it be ok if I used this?*
- *I was wondering if you could give me some ideas.*





Learning Points

Present Perfect Continuous vs Present Perfect

You use the Perfect tenses to talk about an action that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Present Perfect Continuous tense to describe:

- a single activity that lasts a long time and continues to the present
- an action that is repeated over a long period of time and continues to the present
- when a long activity has just stopped

When you use the Present Perfect Continuous tense, you emphasize the **action**.

- *I've been making breakfast all morning. (You want to emphasize the action of making breakfast)*

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience. When you use the Present Perfect tense, you emphasize the **result** of an action (something you did in the past and now you have an experience from that action).

- *I've made breakfast. (The action of making breakfast happened, and the result is that breakfast is now ready)*

Examples:

- *I've been trying to reach you all day.*
- *I've been running around all day.*
- *I've been better.*
- *I've thrown out my back.*
- *I fell down at the bowling alley and haven't been able to walk since.*
- *We've been negotiating with a new publishing house for a different contract.*

